

Word family: ****main / mainly / mains****

****Base word:** main**

****Adverb:** mainly**

****Plural noun form:** mains**

****Useful compounds/extensions:** main reason, main point, main idea, main character, main road, main entrance, main building, main course, main event, main body, mains electricity, water main**

****Part of speech:** adjective (形容詞) / noun in specific technical uses (特定名詞用法) / related adverb (相關副詞)**

Your passage contains:

> “The ****main reason**** I like her so much is that she has always made me feel accepted.”

Here, ****main**** means:

****the most important or principal one among several possible reasons.****

Meaning in this passage

In:

> ****the main reason****

****main**** means:

****the most important, central, or principal.****

You may have several reasons for liking your grandmother:

* she is family;

* she is kind;

* she gives thoughtful advice;

* she has handled hardship well.

But the ****main reason**** is:

> she has always made you feel accepted.

****Meaning:**** The most important, central, or principal among several things.

****繁體中文：** ****最主要的；最重要的；在幾個原因或部分之中居首要地位的****

****中文翻譯：** ******

> “The main reason I like her so much is that she has always made me feel accepted.”

「我這麼喜歡她，**最主要的原因**是她一直都讓我覺得自己是被接納的。」

So:

****main reason = 最主要的原因****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****main = most important/principal (主要的) — 最重要；主要****

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** More important than the other people, things, reasons, or parts being considered.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The ****main reason**** I like her so much is that she makes me feel accepted.”

「我這麼喜歡她的****最主要原因****，是她讓我感到被接納。」

Practice 2

> “Our ****main goal**** is to improve communication.”

「我們的****主要目標****是改善溝通。」

Practice 3

> “The ****main problem**** is lack of time.”

「****主要問題****是時間不足。」

****main = 在數個人、原因、目標、問題或部分之中最重要 / 最核心的****

2. ****main reason/cause (主要原因) — 最主要的原因****

A very common collocation.

Practice 4

> “The **main reason** for the delay was bad weather.”

「延誤的**主要原因**是惡劣天氣。」

Practice 5

> “Stress was the **main cause** of the problem.”

「壓力是問題的**主要成因**。」

main reason/cause = 多個原因中最重要、影響最大的一個

3. **main point (重點)** — 主要重點；核心意思

A major academic/workplace collocation.

Practice 6

> “What is the **main point** of the article?”

「這篇文章的**重點**是甚麼？」

Practice 7

> “Try to remember the **main points**.”

「盡量記住幾個**主要重點**。」

main point = 一段說話、文章、討論等最重要的核心意思

4. **main idea (中心思想 / 主要構思)** — 核心思想；主旨

Practice 8

> “The **main idea** is easy to understand.”

「**中心思想 / 主要意思**很容易理解。」

Practice 9

> “Each paragraph should support the main idea.”

「每一段都應該支持****主旨****。」

****main idea = 文章、段落、計劃等最核心、統領其他內容的想法****

5. ****main purpose/aim (主要目的) — 首要目的；主要目標****

Practice 10

> “The ****main purpose**** of the meeting is to make a decision.”

「會議的****主要目的****是作出決定。」

Practice 11

> “Her main aim is to help people.”

「她的****主要目標****是幫助別人。」

****main purpose/aim = 某項活動最重要、最核心的目的****

6. ****main character (主角) — 主要人物；主角****

A major media/literature compound.

Practice 12

> “She is the ****main character**** in the story.”

「她是故事中的****主角****。」

Practice 13

> “The film follows the main character’s life.”

「電影講述****主角****的人生。」

****main character = 故事、電影、戲劇等最主要、最受關注的人物****

7. ****main subject/topic (主要題目) — 主題；主要議題****

Practice 14

> “The **main topic** of the discussion was family.”

「討論的**主要話題**是家庭。」

Practice 15

> “Education is the main subject of the report.”

「教育是這份報告的**主要主題**。」

main subject/topic = 討論、文章或研究集中處理的最重要題目

8. **main = largest/central part (主要部分) — 主體 ; 主要部分**

A closely related but useful structural sense.

Practice 16

> “The **main part** of the building is still standing.”

「建築物的**主要部分**仍然屹立。」

Practice 17

> “The introduction is short, but the main section is detailed.”

「引言很短，但**主要部分**很詳細。」

main = 構成某個整體最重要 / 最主要的部分

9. **main body (主體) — 主體 ; 正文**

A common formal compound.

Practice 18

> “Put the details in the **main body** of the report.”

「把細節放在報告的**正文 / 主體部分**。」

Practice 19

> “The appendix is separate from the main body.”

「附錄和**正文主體**是分開的。」

main body = 文件、組織、物件等最主要、核心的部分

10. **main = principal route/entrance/building (主要的) — 主要；正門 / 主路等**

A spatial/infrastructural extension.

Practice 20

> “Use the **main entrance**.”

「請使用**正門 / 主要入口**。」

Practice 21

> “The office is in the **main building**.”

「辦公室在**主樓 / 主要大樓**裡。」

main + place/structure = 在幾個入口、建築、道路等之中最主要 / 最重要的一個

11. **main road (主要道路) — 幹道；主路**

Practice 22

> “The hotel is on the **main road**.”

「酒店位於**主要道路 / 幹道**旁。」

Practice 23

> “Avoid the main road during rush hour.”

「繁忙時間避免走**幹道**。」

main road = 區內較重要、交通量通常較大的主要道路

12. **main entrance (正門 / 主要入口) — 正門 ; 主要入口**

Practice 24

> “Please meet me at the **main entrance**.”

「請在**正門 / 主要入口**等我。」

Practice 25

> “The main entrance faces the street.”

「**正門**面向街道。」

main entrance = 建築物最主要、通常最常使用的入口

13. **main building (主樓) — 主要建築 ; 主樓**

Practice 26

> “The meeting room is in the **main building**.”

「會議室在**主樓**裡。」

Practice 27

> “The smaller offices are behind the main building.”

「較小的辦公室在**主要大樓**後面。」

main building = 一組建築中最主要 / 核心的大樓

14. **main course (主菜) — 主菜**

A major meal compound.

Practice 28

> “What would you like for your **main course**?”

「你的****主菜****想吃甚麼？」

Practice 29

> “The main course was served after the soup.”

「湯之後上了****主菜****。」

****main course** = 一餐中最主要、通常份量最大的一道菜

This is a lexicalized compound, not just any “important course.”

15. ****main event** (主要活動 / 重頭戲) — 主要活動；焦點事件

A major compound.

Practice 30

> “The concert is the ****main event**** of the evening.”

「音樂會是今晚的****主要活動 / 重頭戲****。」

Practice 31

> “Everyone was waiting for the main event.”

「大家都在等候****重頭戲****。」

****main event** = 一系列活動中最重要、最受關注的活動

16. ****main attraction** (主要吸引點) — 主要景點；最大吸引力

Practice 32

> “The garden is the hotel’s ****main attraction****.”

「花園是酒店的****主要賣點 / 吸引之處****。」

Practice 33

> “The museum is the town’s main attraction.”

「博物館是小鎮的**主要景點**。」

****main attraction = 最能吸引人前往、觀看或關注的事物****

17. ****main = chief source/supply/channel (主要來源 / 渠道) — 主要的 ; 核心的****

Practice 34

> “Tourism is the country’s ****main source of income****.”

「旅遊業是該國的****主要收入來源****。」

Practice 35

> “Email is our main form of communication.”

「電郵是我們的****主要溝通方式****。」

****main source/form/channel = 在多種來源、方式、渠道中最常用 / 最重要的一個****

18. ****mainstream vs main (主流 ; 家族延伸) — 主流****

A useful lexical family extension, though ****mainstream**** functions as its own lexical item.

Practice 36

> “The idea gradually entered the ****mainstream****.”

「這個想法逐漸進入****主流****。」

Practice 37

> “The film was successful with mainstream audiences.”

「這部電影受到****主流觀眾****歡迎。」

****mainstream = 社會、文化或某領域中最普遍、最被接受的主要趨勢 / 群體****

This is a family extension, not another bare ****main**** sense.

19. ****mainly** (主要地) — 主要 ; 大部分******

A major related adverb.

Practice 38

> “I visit her ****mainly**** on Sundays.”

「我****主要****在星期日探望她。」

Practice 39

> “The audience consisted mainly of students.”

「觀眾****主要****由學生組成。」

****mainly** = 主要地 ; 大部分情況 / 比例屬於某一項******

20. ****mainly because** (主要因為) — 主要是因為******

Practice 40

> “I like the place ****mainly because**** it is quiet.”

「我喜歡這個地方 , ****主要是因為****它很安靜。」

Practice 41

> “She stayed mainly because of her family.”

「她留下來****主要是因為****家人。」

****mainly because** = 多個原因中最主要的原因是.....******

This connects very closely with the passage's:

> ****main reason****

21. ****mainly** = mostly (大部分) — 大多 ; 主要******

Practice 42

> “The group is **mainly** made up of older people.”

「這個群體**大部分**由年長人士組成。」

Practice 43

> “The area is mainly residential.”

「這個地區**主要**是住宅區。」

mainly = 在比例上大多數屬於某一類 / 情況

22. **mains** = public utility supply (公共供應系統) — 水 / 電 / 煤氣總管網

Now **main** develops a genuinely different noun use, usually plural **mains**.

Practice 44

> “The house is connected to the **mains**.”

「這間房屋已接駁到**公共水電供應系統**。」

Practice 45

> “The device runs on mains electricity.”

「這個裝置使用**市電 / 公共電網電力**。」

the mains = 公共供水、供電、煤氣等主要輸送 / 供應網絡

Especially common in British English.

23. **mains electricity/power** (市電) — 市電 ; 電網供電

A major British-English compound.

Practice 46

> “The machine needs **mains power**.”

「這部機器需要使用**市電**。」

Practice 47

> “Disconnect the device from the mains.”

「把裝置從**市電電源**拔除。」

mains electricity/power = 由公共電網輸送到建築物的電力，而不是電池等獨立電源

24. **water main (主要供水管) — 自來水總管；主水管**

A major infrastructure noun sense.

Practice 48

> “A **water main** burst overnight.”

「一條**自來水總管 / 主水管**昨晚爆裂。」

Practice 49

> “Workers repaired the damaged water main.”

「工人修理受損的**主水管**。」

water main = 公共供水系統中的主要大型水管

Here **main** functions as a noun.

25. **gas main (煤氣總管) — 煤氣主喉 / 總管**

Practice 50

> “The road was closed because of a damaged **gas main**.”

「道路因**煤氣總管**受損而封閉。」

Practice 51

> “Engineers checked the gas main.”

「工程師檢查了**煤氣主喉 / 總管**。」

****gas main = 公共煤氣供應系統中的主要輸送管道****

26. ****main line (主線 / 幹線) — 主要線路 ; 鐵路幹線****

A useful compound.

Practice 52

> “The station is on the ****main line****.”

「這個車站位於鐵路****幹線****上。」

Practice 53

> “The branch connects to the main line.”

「支線與****主線****連接。」

****main line = 系統中最主要的運輸、鐵路或其他線路****

27. ****main = principal rather than secondary (主要而非次要) — 首要 ; 核心****

This is the broad semantic contrast underlying many uses.

Practice 54

> “Ignore the minor details and focus on the ****main issue****.”

「先不要理會次要細節，集中於****主要問題****。」

Practice 55

> “We need to separate the main problems from the smaller ones.”

「我們要把****主要問題****和較小的問題分開。」

****main = 與 secondary/minor 相對，屬最重要 / 核心層級****

Important distinction: ****main vs major****

These overlap strongly.

****main****

= the principal / most important one.

****major****

= very important, serious, or large in scale.

Compare:

> “the ****main reason****”

= among several reasons, the principal one.

> “a ****major reason****”

= a very important reason, but not necessarily the single most important one.

This distinction is especially useful.

Important distinction: ****main vs primary****

****main****

= everyday, broad, principal.

****primary****

= first in importance, function, sequence, or classification; often more formal.

> main reason

very natural everyday English.

> primary reason

more formal/analytical.

They often overlap.

Important distinction: **main** vs **principal**

principal

means:

> most important / chief.

It is more formal than **main**.

> main problem

everyday.

> principal cause

formal.

Note:

> **principal** ≠ **principle**

which means:

> 原則.

Important distinction: **main** vs **chief**

chief

= most important/highest-ranking.

It often appears in:

* chief executive;

* chief concern;

* chief reason.

main

is more general and everyday.

> main reason

is usually more natural than:

> chief reason

in ordinary conversation.

Important distinction: **main vs central**

main

= most important/principal.

central

= at the center, or fundamentally important to the structure/idea.

Compare:

> “the main problem”

= most important problem.

> “a central theme”

= theme fundamental to the whole work.

They overlap but emphasize different things.

Important distinction: **main vs key**

key

= critically important to success/understanding.

main

= principal among several.

> main reason

= most important reason.

> key factor

= factor crucial to result.

A **key** factor need not be the single **main** factor.

Important distinction: **main** vs **important**

important

= has significance/value.

main

= ranks first/principal among several relevant things.

You can have:

> several important reasons

but only one may be:

> the main reason.

Important distinction: **main** vs **most**

main

is an adjective:

> the main reason

most

can form superlatives or refer to majority:

> the most important reason

> most people

So:

> main reason

is close to:

> most important reason

but not grammatically identical.

Important distinction: ****main vs majority****

****main****

= principal/most important.

****majority****

= more than half numerically.

A group can have a:

> main concern

without that concern being held by a numerical majority.

Important distinction: ****mainly vs mostly****

These overlap strongly.

****mainly****

often emphasizes:

> principal reason/component.

****mostly****

often emphasizes:

> majority/proportion.

Compare:

> “I went mainly because of her.”

= the principal reason.

> “The audience was mostly students.”

= most people were students.

Both can overlap in many sentences.

Important distinction: ****mainly vs especially****

****mainly****

= chiefly / mostly.

****especially****

= particularly / more than others.

> “I visit mainly on Sundays.”

= most visits happen then.

> “I enjoy visiting, especially on Sundays.”

= Sundays are particularly enjoyable.

Different function.

Important distinction: ****main reason vs only reason****

****main reason****

= most important among potentially several reasons.

****only reason****

= exactly one reason exists.

Your sentence:

> “The main reason I like her...”

does ****not**** mean:

> this is the only reason.

In fact, the passage explicitly gives other reasons afterwards.

This distinction is very important.

Important distinction: **main point vs point******

**a point******

= one idea/argument.

**main point******

= the most important idea/argument.

A presentation can contain many points but one central main point.

Important distinction: **main course vs course******

**course******

can mean:

- * a class;
- * a route/direction;
- * one part of a meal;
- * course of events.

**main course******

specifically means:

> the principal dish of a meal.

The compound has a conventional food meaning.

Important distinction: ****main event vs event****

****event****

= something that happens / organized occasion.

****main event****

= the most important/focal one among several.

So ****main**** introduces ranking/prominence.

Important distinction: ****main entrance vs front entrance****

These often overlap, but not always.

****main entrance****

= most important/commonly used entrance.

****front entrance****

= entrance physically located at the front.

A building's main entrance could theoretically be somewhere other than its geometric front.

Important distinction: ****main road vs wide road****

****main road****

= important principal route.

****wide road****

= physically broad road.

A narrow road can still be a main road, and a very wide private road may not be one.

Important distinction: ****main road vs highway****

****main road****

= principal road in an area.

****highway****

= major public road designed for longer-distance traffic, depending on regional terminology.

Not all main roads are highways.

Important distinction: ****the mains vs main****

This is a major noun/adjective contrast.

Adjective:

> “the main reason”

= 主要原因

Noun plural:

> “connect it to the mains”

= 接駁到公共電力 / 供應網絡

The second has nothing to do with “important reason.”

Important distinction: ****mains electricity vs battery power****

****mains electricity****

= electricity supplied through public electrical infrastructure.

****battery power****

= electricity supplied by a battery.

A device may operate on either or both.

Important distinction: **water main vs water pipe**

water pipe

= any pipe carrying water.

water main

= major public supply pipe.

So every water main is a water pipe, but not every water pipe is a water main.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **main** family is relatively compact but highly useful:

* **main** — most important = 主要的；首要的

* **main reason/cause** = 主要原因

* **main point** = 重點

* **main idea** = 主旨 / 中心思想

* **main purpose/aim** = 主要目的

* **main character** = 主角

* **main subject/topic** = 主要主題

* **main part/section** = 主要部分

* **main body** = 主體 / 正文

* **main entrance** = 正門 / 主要入口

* **main building** = 主樓

* **main road** = 幹道 / 主路

* **main line** = 主線 / 幹線

* **main course** = 主菜

* **main event** = 重頭戲 / 主要活動

* **main attraction** = 主要吸引點 / 景點

* **main source/form** = 主要來源 / 形式

* **mainly** = 主要地 / 大部分

* **mainly because** = 主要因為

* **mainstream** = 主流 (family extension)

* **the mains** = 公共水電煤氣供應網

* **mains electricity/power** = 市電

* **water main** = 自來水總管

* **gas main** = 煤氣總管

The main semantic branches are:

> ****most important / principal****

> ****principal structural route/part****

> ****main utility pipe/supply network****

plus several conventional compounds.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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main — principal	在數個人、原因、目標、問題或部分之中最重要 / 最核心的
main reason/cause	多個原因中最重要、影響最大的一個
main point	說話、文章或討論中最重要的核心意思
main idea	統領文章、段落或構思其他內容的中心思想
main purpose/aim	某項活動最重要、最核心的目的
main character	故事、電影或戲劇中最主要、最受關注的人物
main topic/subject	討論、文章或研究集中處理的主要題目
main part/body	整體中最主要、最核心的部分
main entrance	建築物最主要、通常最常使用的入口
main building	一組建築中最主要 / 核心的大樓
main road	區內較重要、通常交通量較大的主要道路
main line	系統中最主要的鐵路 / 運輸 / 其他線路
main course	一餐中最主要、通常份量最大的一道菜
main event	一系列活動中最重要、最受關注的活動
main attraction	最能吸引人前往、觀看或關注的事物
mainly	主要地；在原因、比例或組成上大部分屬於某一項
mainstream	社會、文化或某領域中最普遍 / 最被接受的主要趨勢
the mains	公共供電、供水、煤氣等主要輸送 / 供應網絡
mains electricity	由公共電網供應到建築物的市電
water main	公共供水系統中的大型主要水管
gas main	公共煤氣供應系統中的主要輸送管道

For your original passage

> “The ****main reason**** I like her so much is that she has always made me feel accepted.”

The exact meaning is:

****main = the most important / principal among several****

Therefore:

> **the main reason**

= **「最主要的原因」**

An especially important nuance is:

> **main reason ≠ only reason**

The passage actually gives several reasons you admire and like your grandmother:

- * she makes you feel accepted;
- * she listens;
- * she gives thoughtful advice;
- * you admire how she handles hardship;
- * her kindness is quiet and steady.

But among all of these:

> feeling accepted

is presented as the **main reason**.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **main reason**

> = 主要原因

> **main point**

> = 重點

> **main idea**

> = 主旨 / 中心思想

> **main character**

> = 主角

> **main entrance**

> = 正門 / 主要入口

> **main road**

> = 主路 / 幹道

> **main building**

> = 主樓

> **main course**

> = 主菜

> **main event**

> = 重頭戲 / 主要活動

> **mainly because**

> = 主要因為

> **mainly students**

> = 主要 / 大部分是學生

> **the mains**

> = 公共水電供應網

> **mains electricity**

> = 市電

> **water main**

> = 自來水總管

So **main** is richer than simply:

> **main = 主要的**

and in your original passage it specifically means:

“the most important reason among several reasons.”